

MOVING WEST

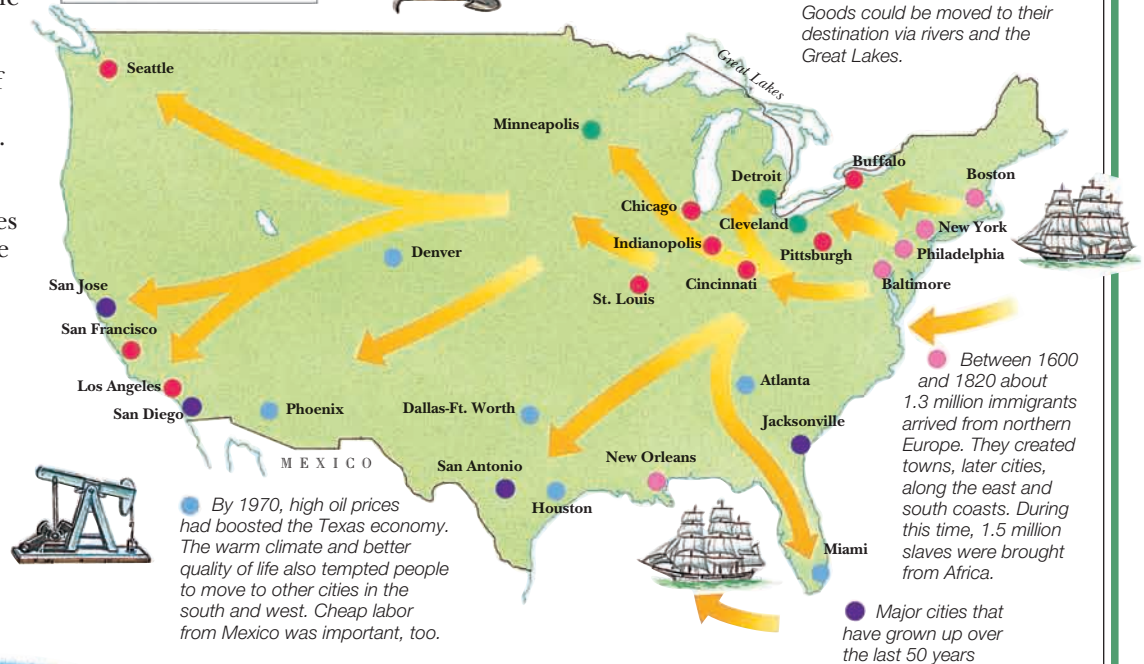
The population of the US has always been mobile, moving to new states in search of work or a better lifestyle. Major events, such as the Great Depression in the 1930s, also forced people to move in the hope of finding work. The general pattern of movement since settlers first arrived is shown on this map. Over the past 30 years or so, more and more people have moved to the “Sun Belt” states of the South and West. These include California, Arizona, Texas, and Florida.



During the mid-1800s, the prospect of finding gold and the spread of the railroads lured people west. By 1920, the aircraft and film industries attracted people to Seattle and Los Angeles.



By 1870, the rapid growth of industry had attracted people to the northeast in search of work. Goods could be moved to their destination via rivers and the Great Lakes.



NATIONAL PARKS

Large areas of the country's most spectacular countryside are protected in more than 350 national parks. Yellowstone National Park, in Wyoming and Montana, was the first park to open, in 1872. Yellowstone provides a safe environment for animals, including bison, elk, antelope, grizzly bear, moose, and deer.

BASEBALL

Baseball is the country's national sport. The first game played between two organized teams took place in New Jersey in 1846. The National League was formed in 1876, the American League in 1901, and today baseball is the most popular spectator sport in the US. It is traditional for the president to pitch the first ball at the start of each new baseball season.



This Zuni artist, a member of the Pueblo tribe, makes and sells silver and turquoise jewelry.

THE FIRST AMERICANS

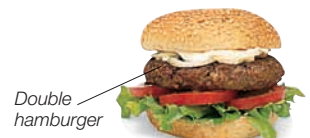
Native Americans, the first inhabitants of the US, today make up less than 1 percent of the population. When Europeans arrived in the 1500s, Native American tribes were decimated by disease. They lost many of their homelands and were forced over time to live on reservations – land allotted to them by the government. Despite these hardships, many tribal traditions and languages still survive.

LARGEST TRIBES

Cherokee	308,000
Navajo	219,000
Chippewa	104,000
Sioux	103,000
Choctaw	82,000
Pueblo	53,000

AMERICAN CULTURE

The influence of US culture can be seen all over the world. Fast foods, such as hamburgers, hot dogs, and soft drinks, as well as characters from films and TV shows, are recognized in cities from Berlin to Beijing. This “selling of America” is a billion-dollar industry and plays a vital part in the US economy.



Find out more

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